



Nima Thing

Computational social science researcher focused on political communication, disinformation, and digital-trace data.

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Education

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| Hertie School , Data Science for Public Policy <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Main fields: Data Science, Governance, Advanced Quantitative Methods.• Core subjects: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing, Causal Inference.• Data for Good Full Scholarship, Dieter Schwarz Stiftung. | Berlin, Germany
Aug 2023 – June 2025 |
| The Open Institute for Social Science , Research and Writing in Social Science <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Research design, critical epistemology and methodology, ethnographic theory. | Lalitpur, Nepal
Aug 2021 – June 2022 |
| Tribhuvan University , Electronics and Communication Engineering | Kathmandu, Nepal
2014 – 2018 |

Experience

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| University of Bern , Research Assistant, Antisemitism in LLMs
Anti-semitic speech detection and propagation by generative AI. <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Built and benchmarked a 5-model LLM classification pipeline for a hate-speech study, improving macro F1 from ~0.68 to ~0.86 and scaling analysis to 8,523 outputs. | Remote
Aug 2026 – Aug 2026
1 month |
| Policy Entrepreneurs, Inc. (PEI) , Technical Consultant, Gen Z Digital Movement Study
Provided computational social science expertise for a study on Gen Z digital movements in Nepal. <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Built social network analysis on Nepali 5185 Reddit Authors and explored cross-platform engagement patterns (Hashtag Co-occurrence on Facebook) during Pre-GenZ protest; provided technical guidance on data collection and analysis. | Remote
May 2026 – June 2026
2 months |
| logiq.media , Computational Social Science Researcher & Lead Developer (part-time)
Volunteer researcher (Jan–Mar 2026); part-time from Apr 2026. <ul style="list-style-type: none">• On SHIFT (Shaping Informed Frameworks for Trust), a 13-country European Narratives Observatory project. Builds audience segmentation and narrative-mapping pipelines to identify bridging actors and high-risk narrative clusters for counter-narrative experiments.• Lead developer of ElfBot, a prototype for AI-based Facebook comment moderation (ingestion/polling/webhooks backend; classifier rules and fine-tuned LLMs) detecting trolls and toxic comments with human-in-the-loop review; v1 focused on disinformation triage, surfacing coordinated-behavior signals for analyst review (intro-video).• Co-authored empirical commentary on the gap between fact-checking output volume and public reception in contested feeds — submitted to the HKS Misinformation Review. | Berlin / Remote
Jan 2026 – present
8 months |

Weizenbaum Institute & University of Bern , Short-term Computer Engineer Research infrastructure for longitudinal platform auditing. - Designed reproducible, modular web-scraping framework (Botasaurus) for algorithmic auditing of Yandex and Google in Kremlin-disinformation research — GitHub. - Implemented fingerprint evasion, proxy orchestration, CAPTCHA handling, and structured logging; documented for social-science researchers.	Berlin, Germany Dec 2025 – Dec 2025 1 month
Welthungerhilfe — Digital Services & Operations , Werkstudent (Data Engineering) Bridging data science with humanitarian research at a leading international NGO. - Developed and maintained automated data pipelines (Python, PySpark, Microsoft Fabric, Azure Data Factory) integrating employee and training data from external APIs — eliminating manual processes and improving data accuracy. - Built robust API integrations (token management, pagination, rate limiting, error handling); improved pipeline logging and monitoring with real-time progress tracking; performed technical error analysis and optimization of pipelines. - Led proof-of-concept for automated metadata ingestion and data lineage (OpenMetadata, PyApacheAtlas, MS Purview); presented governance framework at internal workshop with Viadee served as technical point of contact for teams and stakeholders.	Bonn, Germany Apr 2024 – July 2025 1 year 4 months
Immobilien Scout GmbH , Quality Specialist (Mobile) Executed 20+ integration and A/B tests on Android/iOS; implemented Maestro automation framework improving efficiency by ~30%.	Berlin, Germany Oct 2023 – Apr 2024 7 months
Qniverse Pvt. Ltd. , Lead Automation Engineer - Led QA automation and team mentorship for international research projects; achieved 90% API test coverage ahead of schedule. - Built browser automation and web scraping infrastructure (Selenium, Playwright) used across multiple UKRI-funded projects. - Employment Guru Award (2023) for QA leadership and process optimization.	Kathmandu, Nepal Aug 2022 – Sept 2023 1 year 2 months
Verisk Nepal Pvt. Ltd. , Software Engineer, Data Analytics - Developed performance-testing and schema-comparison tools (.NET Core/C#) for REST APIs; reduced deployment cycles from hours to minutes. - Built Python regression test suites for AWS/Snowflake data-ingestion ETL pipeline.	Lalitpur, Nepal Feb 2019 – Aug 2022 3 years 7 months

Volunteer

DeepTrace — South Asia Deepfake Detection , Research Assistant (Volunteer) Dataset annotation and benchmark development for underrepresented contexts. - Established annotation guidelines and benchmarks for AI-generated visual content in South Asian contexts. - Contributed dataset-collection UI/UX design — deepfake-research.org.	Remote Nov 2025 – Jan 2026
Koç University (EnlightenAI / Human-AI Interaction) , Summer Research Intern Social media data tooling and NLP feature engineering. - Built TikTok web-scraping and metadata tooling; comparative assessment of third-party data providers. - Contributed Named Entity Recognition features for search models with Human-AI Interaction team.	Istanbul, Turkey July 2025 – Sept 2025

Projects

Pre-Mobilization Reorganization of Online Discourse before Nepal's September 2025 Gen-Z Protest (In Progress) Ongoing cross-platform analysis examining network restructuring before mass political protest. Uses Meta Content Library and structured Reddit collection (ArcticShift API). Accepted poster (Reddit Specific) — see How Are You, Democracy? 2026 .	2026 – present
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Beyond the Ballot — TikTok Virality and Political Engagement in Nepal's 2022 Elections MSc thesis (Hertie School, submitted and completed 2025; Prof. Simon Munzert). Revised after committee feedback; not yet published as a journal article. Multimodal ML study of 28,165 videos; full model AUC 0.800. Code . Presented at TCSS 2026 and SICSS-Saarbrücken 2025 .	2024 – 2025
Stance Polarization & Community Structure on Bluesky ~156K posts: zero-shot stance classification, toxicity scoring (Perspective API), author-network analysis. Poster at SICSS-Saarbrücken 2025 .	2025 – 2025
Mapping Elite Attention Ecosystems on Instagram (Nepal) Network analysis of influential activists and attention structure around Nepal's Gen-Z digital movement. Proposal .	2026 – 2026

Presentations

How Are You, Democracy? (Karlsruhe, 2026) Accepted poster — Beyond the ban: co-engagement network signals on Nepali Reddit in the run-up to the Sep 8 Gen Z protest (25 June 2026). See Pre-Protest Reorganization project .
Youth in a Digital Society (University of Potsdam, 2026) Accepted poster for my Master Thesis (8 October 2026).
TCSS 2026 (Koç University, Istanbul) Talk — TikTok virality and political engagement in Nepal's 2022 election. Slides . See Beyond the Ballot project .
SICSS-Saarbrücken & MPIB (2025) Posters — TikTok virality and political engagement in Nepal's 2022 election (SICSS poster , MPIB poster), and stance polarization on Bluesky. See Beyond the Ballot and Stance Polarization on Bluesky projects.
SSaLM, Weizenbaum Institute (2025) Poster — deploying DistilBERT to detect and mitigate information bias. Poster .

Awards

Data for Good Scholarship Full scholarship for the Hertie School's Msc. Data Science for Public Policy programme. Dieter Schwarz Stiftung	2023
Employment Guru Award Recognition for QA automation leadership. Qniverse Pvt. Ltd.	2023
ESSA Scholarship BEHAVE Summer School on Agent-Based Modelling for Social Scientists. ESSA	2022
Verisk Way to Go Recognition for API testing and data-analysis tooling. Verisk Analytics	2020

Skills

Computational Social Science

Machine Learning & NLP

Engineering & Data

Languages

English

Professional / fluent

Nepali

Native

Hindi

Professional

German

A2 (beginner)

Certificates

Digital Governance

2025

Algorithmic Fairness

2025